

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Agile Testing Cheat Sheet

How a tester works across an agile sprint — roles, ceremonies and habits.

Introduction

Most QA roles are on agile teams. This cheat sheet summarises the Scrum essentials and the tester's role across a sprint, so you can contribute confidently from day one.

Scrum at a Glance

Element	Summary
Roles	Product Owner, Scrum Master, Developers (includes testers)
Artefacts	Product backlog, Sprint backlog, Increment
Sprint	Short fixed iteration (often 1-2 weeks)

Ceremonies & Tester Focus

Ceremony	Tester contribution
Refinement	Ask "what if" questions; flag testability gaps
Sprint planning	Raise test effort and risks
Daily stand-up	Share progress and blockers
Sprint review	Help demo; confirm acceptance criteria met
Retrospective	Suggest process improvements

Tester Habits Across a Sprint

- Day 1: review stories, write test ideas, prepare data.
- Mid-sprint: test stories as they complete; log and retest defects.
- End: support the review; verify acceptance criteria; balance regression.
- Throughout: test little and often, collaborate early (three amigos).

Common Mistakes

- Batching all testing to the last two days.
- Staying silent in refinement, then finding gaps during testing.
- Treating QA as a separate gate rather than part of the team.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

"I like to get involved at refinement to prevent defects early" is a line that signals modern, senior-minded agile QA in any interview.